

Day 7 — The Integration Debate

Module: Ayurveda (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students articulate three positions on integrating Ayurveda into modern healthcare and defend one with steel-manned counter-arguments.

Materials

- Whiteboard
- Optional: brief printed extracts on AYUSH ministry policy + Indian Medical Association statements

Flow

Warm-up (3 min)

Brief: today is structured debate. Three positions.

Three positions (5 min)

Position	One-line	Defenders
A — Full integration	Ayurveda alongside biomedicine; AYUSH practitioners can offer first-line care	AYUSH Ministry; many Indian Ayurveda practitioners
B — Selective integration	Use Ayurveda where evidence supports; biomedicine where it leads	Patwardhan et al. (2015); evidence-based traditional medicine movement
C — Separation	Ayurveda as cultural-historical study; biomedicine for actual treatment	Indian Medical Association (some positions); skeptical scientists

Debate (25 min)

- 5 min: groups by position.
- 10 min: prep — 2 arguments + 1 steel-manned counter to each.
- 10 min: structured debate (3 min/group + 1 min cross).

Oral assessment (during)

Teacher scores 5 random students on: position clarity, evidence use, counter-argument fairness, listening.

Wrap-up (12 min)

- 3 students share if their view shifted.
- Note: *“This is the most politically loaded session. Both extreme positions have problems. The mature position is somewhere in the middle, defended with evidence.”*

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Take position you disagree with.
- **Tier down:** Use prepared 2-min argument.

Teacher notes

- AYUSH ministry is real, contemporary, politically significant. Honour the political reality.
- Some students from medical families have strong priors. Help them articulate their position rigorously.

Citation(s) used

- AYUSH Ministry policy documents.
- Patwardhan et al. (2015).
- Various IMA statements.